A Secure Living After Wages

One-page policy brief | 12 October 2026

Decision: If AI makes wages unable to support most people, make basic living conditions independent of paid work. Provide dependable cash, extra support for greater needs, and access to food, housing, energy, and health care. A payment alone cannot remove shortages.

What to do, and in what order

Start tax reform and essential supply projects now. The stages overlap. Emergency relief must not wait for a public fund to grow.

1. **Define the promise now.** Parliament sets the minimum living standard, who receives support, payment dates, and rules for price changes. Name the bodies responsible for payment, services, and appeals.
2. **Build access and supply in parallel.** Payment agencies test enrolment, urgent payments, appeals, and working backups. Local authorities start essential projects. Fund construction and later operation. Keep existing support working.
3. **Pay when income fails.** Use lawful emergency support based on need. Do not require proof that AI caused each loss. Check debts and benefit rules so new payments do not leave gaps in support.
4. **Secure permanent funding.** The finance ministry replaces dependence on wage taxes with a costed mix of continuing revenue. Protect a basic payment; keep any variable dividend separate. Publish cash reserves and debt obligations.
5. **Review before optional increases.** Check revenue, essential access, and delivery at least annually. Correct failures first. This review must not delay emergency relief or payment adjustments already required by law.

How to fund the plan

Continuing support: Start with the public budget. Assess taxes on profits and investment income, improve collection, and count savings only where old costs actually end. Use receipts after losses elsewhere in the budget. If profit receipts are weak, assess broader taxes with rebates. High AI output does not guarantee high taxable profits.

Public ownership: Add investment income only after counting purchase costs, fees, risk, and debt costs. Asset value is not ready cash. Do not count the same profits as both taxes and dividends. Do not base basic payments on voluntary foreign promises.

Transition and investment: Use funded cash reserves for temporary payment gaps. Use borrowing for approved investment or temporary support only with a credible repayment plan. Restore reserves after use. Neither reserves nor borrowing can explain away a permanent funding gap.

Publish three linked accounts: yearly revenue and running costs; construction and asset purchases; cash receipts and payments by date. Include needs support, administration, payment errors, interest, and debt repayments in the relevant account. Keep other public duties funded. Do not use the same money twice.

Check the result

Report essential access, resources left after living costs, debt payments, late benefits, and appeal outcomes. Publish who pays, who gains, and any unmet promise. Name who must correct each failure. Measure success by secure living conditions, not AI output alone.

Basis and limits: This brief summarises A Secure Living After Wages, which combines 15 studies. It proposes a plan, not a forecast. No national payment amount or tax rate is established. AI-assisted draft; no human peer review.